

What is an API

- **Definition:** API (Application Programming Interface) is a set of rules that lets one software application interact with another.
- **Purpose:** Allows communication between different systems.
- **Example:**
 - Weather app using OpenWeather API to get weather data.
 - Payment gateway API (like Razorpay or PayPal) used by e-commerce sites.
- **Types of APIs:**
 - Web APIs, REST APIs, GraphQL APIs, and SDKs.
- **REST API Basics:**
 - Uses HTTP methods (GET, POST, PUT, DELETE).
 - Data often sent in JSON format.
- **Benefits:**
 - Reusability, scalability, and faster integration.